



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

You can't always take everything so seriously!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and reactions.
- I can show I understand someone's feelings or situation.
- I can explain my opinion about past events.

Ask your partner:

- What do you do if someone is very late for an appointment? Do you wait for them?
- Do you think you're a patient person? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Peter can't handle people who are always **fashionably late**.*

* "Fashionably late" is an expression. It means always arriving late to give the impression that you are busy.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Rosa:** Peter! I'm so sorry again! I must have forgotten about the time.
- Peter:** That's alright. A buddy of mine was here, so I caught up with him. I had started to eat something with him before you finally arrived. I thought you might have stood me up.
- Rosa:** You sound irritable. I understand you like punctuality, but you might be taking this obsession a little too far.
- Peter:** I just find it exasperating when people aren't on time.
- Rosa:** You might want to loosen up, you know? I had planned on being on time until you started texting me every 5 minutes 2 hours before our date!
- Peter:** I thought you could have used a reminder ...
- Rosa:** I certainly didn't need 30 messages for that!
- Peter:** I think I may have exaggerated. I had never dated an Italian until I met you. I can't handle you being late every time we go out.
- Rosa:** Let me get it straight: are you breaking up with me? I may not be the most punctual person in the world, but I think you may be making a mistake. You could be a bit more open-minded, you know?
- Peter:** I can't be relaxed when I'm out of my comfort zone, sorry.
- Rosa:** Well, I'll get straight to the point. I had never dated a baseball nerd until I met you. I think this may be the first and last time.





Let's Practice!

Peter is talking with Rosa, his new date.

Instructions: Use the words in the boxes to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

sorry	might be carrying	exasperating	loosen back	relax
needy	must be getting	exhilarating	loosen up	realistic
nerdy	may be taking	exiting	loosen down	relaxing

1. I'm so _____ again!
2. I understand you like punctuality, but you _____ this obsession a little too far.
3. I just find it _____ when people aren't on time.
4. You might want to _____, you know?
5. I can't _____ when I'm out of my comfort zone, sorry.



Let's Practice!

Rosa is explaining to Peter that things are not going well between them.

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. _____ about the time.
2. _____ until you started texting me 2 hours before our date!
3. _____ an American until I met you.
4. _____ you were a cool guy, but I was mistaken!
5. I had never had to _____ with someone for such a thing!

Word Bank

- I had never dated
- on being on time
- I had planned
- I had thought
- I must have forgotten
- break up



Extension Activity

My personal pet peeves.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a list of five of your personal pet peeves (things that bother you). E.g. I hate it when people are late. It bothers me when people chew really loud.
- Present your list of pet peeves to a partner.
- Compare and discuss your lists.
- Create a new top-5 list by combining your list with your partners.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I make a list of things that bother me.

☐ ☐

I share my list with a partner.

☐ ☐

I combine my work with a partner's work.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to stand someone up** (verb): to intentionally fail to meet somebody when you said you would
e.g. I thought you might have stood me up.
- irritable** (adjective): easily annoyed
e.g. You sound irritable. What's wrong?
- exasperating** (adjective): extremely annoying
e.g. I just find it exasperating when people aren't on time.
- to loosen up** (verb): to stop worrying and become more relaxed
e.g. You might want to loosen up, you know?
- let me get it straight** (expression): to understand something clearly
e.g. Let me get it straight: are you breaking up with me?
- to the point** (expression): relevant; pertinent to the matter at hand
e.g. Well, I'll get straight to the point.
- open-minded** (adjective): willing to consider and accept other people's ideas and opinions
e.g. You could be a bit more open-minded, you know?





Learning Points

Expressing Understanding Using Modals (Modals for Possibility and Certainty)

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

*I **must have forgotten** about the time.*

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>I can't handle you being late.</i>	It's not possible for me to handle you being late.
<i>I may have exaggerated.</i>	It's possible that I may have exaggerated.
<i>I may not be the most punctual person in the world.</i>	It's not likely that I am the most punctual person in the world.

Examples:

- I understand you like punctuality, but you may be taking this obsession a little too far.*
- You might want to loosen up, you know?*





Learning Points

Expressing an Opinion About Past Events (Simple Past vs Past Perfect)

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*I **had started** to eat something with him before you finally arrived.*

Which event happened *first*? I ate something.

Which event happened *later*? You arrived.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

I had never dated an Italian until I met you.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Examples:

- *I had planned on being on time until you started texting me every 5 minutes 2 hours before our date!*
- *A buddy of mine was here, so I caught up with him.*
- *I had started to eat something with him before you finally arrived.*

